ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE L

A YES vote on Measure L is a vote for a safe high school for our students.

Our District works hard to take care of our 50+ year-old high school with limited funding, but decades of wear and tear have resulted in serious safety concerns that must be addressed.

Gas lines, storm drains, sewer systems, and plumbing infrastructure at the high school are all failing. This has caused flooding, mold, sewage backups, and 17 roof leaks in the last year alone at Mountain Empire High School. Aging water and fire suppression systems force the school to close several times each year.

These issues directly affect our students' ability to learn.

That is why we need Measure L. Updating our high school now will address basic safety needs for our students and will prevent costly delayed maintenance expenses.

Measure L Includes Strict Fiscal Safeguards:

- All funds must be spent on our local schools and cannot be taken by the State
- Annual independent audits and a citizens' oversight committee will ensure funds are spent as promised
- A detailed project list describing how bond funds will be used
- No funds could be used for administrator salaries or pensions

Yes on Measure L; Save Our High School

- Repair or replace deteriorating roofs, plumbing, heating, ventilation, gas lines, sewer lines, and electrical systems
- Remove hazardous materials including asbestos, lead pipes, and mold
- Ensure proper access for students with disabilities
- Provide modern science labs, agriculture and career technical facilities and equipment
- Repair, replace, or reconstruct deteriorating classrooms and school facilities that don't meet current building safety standards

Essential repairs and upgrades are now critical to keep our students safe and to prepare them for success in college and careers.

Vote YES on L. Save our High School. Safeguard their future.

MARK KERSEY
President, San Diego County Taxpayers Association

ED KETCHUM
First Responder

BILL LEBLANC
Retired MEUSD Teacher (1995-2026)

JEFF OSBORNE
Local Business Owner

TREVOR GAREWAL
Descanso Hay and Feed

No Argument Against Measure L was filed with the Office of the Registrar of Voters

FULL TEXT OF MEASURE L

MOUNTAIN EMPIRE UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT
SCHOOL SAFETY, RENOVATION AND CONSTRUCTION MEASURE

This measure may be known and referred to as the "Mountain Empire Unified School District School Safety, Renovation and Construction Measure" or as "Measure L".

BOND AUTHORIZATION

By approval of this measure by at least 55% of the voters of the Mountain Empire Unified School District (the "District") voting on the measure, the District shall be authorized to issue and sell bonds of up to $23,000,000 in aggregate principal amount to provide financing for the specific school facilities projects listed under the heading entitled "BOND PROJECT LIST" below (the "Bond Project List"), and allow the District to qualify to receive potential State of California matching grant funds, subject to all of the accountability safeguards specified below.

ACCOUNTABILITY SAFEGUARDS

The provisions in this section are specifically included in this measure in order that the voters and taxpayers of the District may be assured that their money will be spent to address specific school facilities needs of the District, all in compliance with the requirements of Article XIIIA, Section 1(b)(3) of the Constitution of the State of California (the "California Constitution"), and the Strict Accountability in Local School Construction Bonds Act of 2000 (codified at Sections 15264 and following of the California Education Code).

Evaluation of Needs. The Board of Education of the District (the "Board") has evaluated the facilities needs of the District to determine which projects to finance from a local bond at this time. To address the facilities needs of the District, the Board deems it necessary and advisable to fund the specific school facilities projects listed in the Bond Project List. The Board hereby certifies that it has evaluated safety, class size reduction and information technology needs in developing the Bond Project List.

Limitations on Use of Bonds. Proceeds from the sale of bonds authorized by this measure shall be used only for the construction, reconstruction, rehabilitation, or replacement of school facilities, including the furnishing and equipping of school facilities, or the acquisition or lease of real property for school facilities, and not for any other purpose, including teacher and administrator salaries and other school operating expenses. More specifically, the Bond Project List provides for the specific projects the District proposes to finance with proceeds from the sale of bonds authorized by this measure and such proceeds shall be applied only to those specific purposes.

Independent Citizens' Oversight Committee. In accordance with and pursuant to California Education Code Section 15278 *et seq* ., the Board shall establish an independent citizens' oversight committee, within 60 days of the date that the Board enters the election results on its minutes pursuant to Section 15274 of the California Education Code, to ensure that (a) bond revenues are expended only for the purposes specified in Article XIIIA, Section 1(b)(3) of the California Constitution, and (b) that no funds are used for any teacher or administrative salaries or other school operating expenses. In accordance with Section 15282 of the California Education Code, the citizens' oversight committee shall consist of at least seven members and shall include a member active in a business organization representing the business community located within the District, a member active in a senior citizens' organization, a member active in a bona fide taxpayers' organization, a member that is a parent or guardian of a child enrolled in the District, and a member that is both a parent or guardian of a child enrolled in the District and active in a parent-teacher organization. The committee may be comprised of the same members of the citizens' oversight committees for other District bond measures. No employee or official of the District and no vendor, contractor or consultant of the District shall be appointed to the citizens' oversight committee.

Annual Performance Audits. In compliance with the requirements of Article XIIIA, Section 1(b)(3)(C) of the California Constitution, and the Strict Accountability in Local School Construction Bonds Act of 2000, the Board shall conduct an annual, independent performance audit to ensure